



المنتدى السعودي للإعلام
SAUDI MEDIA FORUM

SBA
هيئة الإذاعة والتلفزيون

الهيئة العامة
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GENERAL AUTHORITY
OF MEDIA REGULATION



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Saudi Data & AI Authority

وزارة الإعلام
Ministry of Media



AI Principles in Media

2026

Public

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Executive Summary

In the light of the accelerating use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in media, alongside the growing challenges related to deepfakes, public opinion manipulation, algorithmic influence, fraudulent content that is misleading and false, and the difficulty of regulating content among cross-border digital platforms.

This document establishes guiding principles for the use of AI across the media content lifecycle, including production, editing, publication, and redistribution on media and digital platforms to ensure responsible and safe use, mitigate associated risks, preserve media integrity, and protect societal values and individual rights.

Based on the Anti-Cyber Crime Law, the Personal Data Protection Law and its executive regulations, the regulatory requirements issued by relevant authorities in the fields of data and AI, and in accordance with the AI Ethics Principles and Deepfake Guidelines, this document forms part of the national efforts to guide the use of AI technologies in the media sector.

First: Definitions

For the purpose of this document, the following terms shall have the meanings indicated below, unless the context requires otherwise:

Artificial Intelligence (AI): is a collection of technologies that can enable a machine or system to sense, comprehend, act, and learn.

Media Channels: The means through which media content is published and broadcasted.

Entities: Public or private entities that produce, publish, or redistribute content generated or supported by AI through traditional media, digital content platforms, or other publishing channels.

Media Content: Material directed to the public, whether written, read, printed, filmed, digital, virtual, interactive, or audiovisual, in all its forms and means, including new formats, and excluding content characterized as private correspondence.

AI-Assisted Content: Any media content created, modified, or enhanced, fully or partially, using AI technologies.

Deepfake: Artificial content created using AI technologies to simulate or imitate real individuals in voice, image, or video.

Misleading Content: Any content that contains incorrect, fabricated, or distorted information that is produced, published, or redistributed with the intent to mislead, deceive, or unlawfully influence public opinion, the reputation, positions, or decisions of individuals.

False Content: Any content that contains incorrect, incomplete, or out-of-context information that is produced, published, or redistributed without the intent to mislead or cause harm, often resulting from error, misunderstanding, or inaccurate information transfer.

Fraudulent Content: Any content that contains false representations or impersonations intended to commit fraud, deceive, or unlawfully obtain money, data, or other benefits.

Public Figures: Individuals with public presence or influence, including officials, media personnel, opinion makers, and celebrities.

Content Creators: Individuals who create, prepare, edit, publish, or republish media content through any means or platform, including influencers, independent journalists, and digital producers, whether using AI technologies fully or partially.

Digital Content Platforms: Digital platforms that enable the broadcasting, presentation, display, production, or publication of media content, or the provision of services through electronic means, including social media websites or platforms.

Cross-Border Platforms: Digital content platforms that are managed or hosted outside the local geographic area and provide content to the public within Saudi Arabia.

Impact Assessment: A systematic process for estimating and analyzing the potential social, ethical, cultural, health, and economic impacts of the use of AI in media.

Second: Objective

This document aims to achieve the following:

- Guide the use of AI technologies in the media sector based on responsible practices and risk management.
- Enhance the reliability of media content and protect public trust.
- Contribute to reducing the risks of misinformation, deepfakes, privacy violations, and infringements of intellectual property rights.
- Clarify the responsibilities of media entities, platforms, and content creators.

Third: Target Groups

These principles apply to:

- Government and private sector entities.
- Digital content platforms, including cross-border platforms, where the content is directed at or made available to the public within Saudi Arabia.
- Content creators and individuals involved in the production, editing, publication, or republication of media content.
- Media users and digital content platforms, when producing, circulating, or republishing media content supported by AI.
- Any media content created, modified, enhanced, or circulated, fully or partially, using AI technologies.

Fourth: Context and Risks

AI contributes to the development of media practices by enhancing operational efficiency, accelerating content production, improving content analysis and distribution, and expanding audience reach across media and digital content platforms. It also opens new horizons for media creativity, content personalization, and enhanced user experience.

However, this increasing use also involves potential risks that require careful and balanced regulation, the most prominent of which include:

- Difficulty in distinguishing between real and AI-generated content, which would decrease trust in media outlets.
- Producing or amplifying misleading, fragmented, or decontextualized content, whether during production or through republication and circulation.
- Misuse of deepfake technologies, particularly involving public figures, which may harm reputations, undermine public trust, and threaten societal stability, creating security and political risks.
- Illegitimate influence on public opinion through algorithms and automated content recommendation and ranking systems.
- Violation of privacy and individual rights, including the misuse of individuals' images, voices, or personal data without legal justification, particularly concerning children.
- Challenges related to intellectual property violations, including the use of AI to generate content that may infringe copyright or related rights, the reproduction of protected works without a license, or ambiguity in attributing automatically generated content.

Accordingly, this document adopts an approach that balances enabling media innovation for the protection of society, which is grounded in transparency, responsibility, and proportionality to the level of impact. It ensures compliance with relevant laws, regulations, and controls, including the Anti-Cyber Crime Law, the Personal Data Protection Law and its executive regulations, and the regulatory requirements issued by relevant authorities in the fields of data and AI, in accordance with AI Ethics Principles and Deepfake Guidelines.

Fifth: Principles



First Principle: Transparency and Disclosure

- Disclosure of the use of AI technologies in the production, modification, or enhancement of media content, which includes informing the public or using watermarks and other disclosure methods for AI-generated content, to enable audiences to understand the nature and source of the content and to reduce confusion between real and AI-generated content.
- Disclosure should be proportionate to the nature of the content and its potential psychological, physical, and intellectual impact on users. Disclosure is necessary when AI-supported content clearly affects public perception, attitudes, behavior, or health, particularly in news, analytical, or widely impactful content.
- Disclosure applies to digital content platforms and media outlets at the time of publication, and to content creators at the time of creation or republication. It also includes, where applicable, disclosure of the role of algorithms or automated systems in generating, organizing, or recommending content, given their direct impact on shaping public opinion.



Second Principle: Credibility and Integrity of Information

- Adhering to professional standards in media content when using AI, including accuracy, verification of information, and presenting content in its correct context without distortion or alteration.
- Responsibility extends across all stages of content handling and entails the obligation of all parties involved in its production, publication, or redistribution to preserve credibility and information integrity across all forms and channels, whether through traditional media, digital content platforms, or content creators' accounts.
- The use of AI to produce, publish, or republish misleading, false, or contextually deficient content is prohibited where it may mislead public opinion or unlawfully influence trends or decisions, regardless of intent or means of publication.



Third Principle: Privacy Protection and Public Figures

- Respecting individuals' privacy and protecting their data and personal rights by not using their photos, voices, or data, or simulating their identities using AI technologies, without legal justification or explicit consent, in accordance with relevant data protection laws and regulations.
- Content related to public figures is considered highly sensitive due to its broad societal impact and must therefore be handled with heightened caution with strict safeguards against the misuse of AI technologies, including deepfakes, identity theft, or the attribution of statements or actions not made by them.
- Content involving defamation, extortion, threats, abuse, exploitation, or deception, as well as any use that may harm individuals or communities or undermine public trust in the media. Particular protection applies to content targeting children, including the use of their photos, voices, or data, or simulating them using AI technologies without legal justification, or exposing them to content inappropriate for their age or with harmful psychological or social effects.



Fourth Principle: Prohibition of Misleading Content

- The use of AI technologies to produce, publish, redistribute deepfake content, or any harmful, misleading, offensive fraudulent content, or content that violates applicable regulations, societal values, or approved content standards, is prohibited.
- Entities and individuals must take appropriate measures, according to their respective roles, to monitor such content, limit its spread, and address it upon discovery.



Fifth Principle: Responsibility and Accountability Across the Content Lifecycle

- Entities, digital content platforms, and content creators bear responsibility for AI-supported content throughout its lifecycle, from production and publication through redistribution.
- The use of AI technologies does not exempt any party from professional or legal responsibility, and penalties and sanctions prescribed under applicable regulations apply in the event of violations.



Sixth Principle: Integrity and Impartiality

- Entities and content creators must uphold neutrality and integrity when using AI technologies in the production or distribution of media content, ensuring that such technologies are not used to favor any group, entity, or viewpoint without professional or legal justification.
- Algorithmic bias and profiling resulting from the use of AI in content must be limited, and efforts must be made to ensure fairness and equity in the representation of individuals and different groups.
- The use of AI technologies to abuse, discriminate against, bully, or disparage individuals or groups, promote negative stereotypes, or undermine social cohesion and community peace is prohibited.



Seventh Principle: Societal Awareness and Public Empowerment

- Enhancing societal awareness is a fundamental element in managing the risks of AI in media and includes empowering the public to understand the nature of AI-assisted content, distinguish between real and AI-generated content, and recognize the role and limitations of automated systems in producing or distributing content. Raising public awareness of responsibilities when sharing or reposting content, encouraging verification of accuracy and context before re-sharing, promoting the reporting of misleading or incorrect content, and supporting initiatives that enhance media literacy.



Eighth Principle: Impact Assessment and Regulatory Compliance

- Conducting appropriate impact assessments before deploying AI technologies in cases with wide-ranging effects, particularly in news, political content, or large-scale public campaigns, to evaluate potential social and ethical impacts and implement measures to mitigate associated risks.
- Media and digital content platforms, including cross-border platforms, must comply with local regulations and content controls when targeting audiences within Saudi Arabia, regardless of platform location or the operating entity.

Sixth: Mechanisms for Dealing with Violations

In the event of suspected deepfake content, misleading or harmful content resulting from the use of AI technologies, or any breach of applicable regulations or content controls, the matter shall be addressed in accordance with the following principles:

- Reporting through channels approved by the relevant regulatory authority or the concerned media platform, ensuring prompt response and accurate handling.
- Media entities or digital content platforms must take immediate measures to halt the dissemination of non-compliant content or restrict access to it until its status is verified.
- Cooperation with relevant authorities by providing the information necessary for verification and processing, including content sources and the mechanisms of its production or circulation, when required by law.
- Addressing the impact of non-compliant content through correction, removal, or notification, as appropriate, while preserving the rights of affected parties and enhancing public trust.
- Enhancing preventive measures to avoid recurrence, including reviewing internal policies and strengthening monitoring and auditing mechanisms.

The foregoing does not affect any other regulatory obligations established under applicable laws and regulations.

Seventh: Conclusion

These principles constitute a national guiding framework for the use of AI in media and complement applicable laws, regulations, and content controls. They shall not be interpreted in a manner that undermines the competencies of regulatory authorities or exempts any party from existing regulatory obligations.

These principles may be reviewed and updated periodically as technological and regulatory developments evolve, to maintain a balanced approach that supports media innovation, protects society, and strengthens trust in media content.

This document also calls on media entities, digital content platforms, and content creators to adopt these principles within their policies and professional practices, contributing to the development of a responsible, safe, and reliable media environment amid rapid digital transformation.



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